Finding effective web content

Chapter 9 analysis: readability, understandability, and engagement · Katherine Conklin

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I explored the websites of BarkBox, ThredUp, and charity: water to look at how they create readable, understandable, and engaging web content. They used practices we see often in class assignments and the textbook.

BarkBox

A playful, friendly tone that matches its brand perfectly. Bold headers, lots of white space, and short sentences make the content easy to skim. The blog features stories that connect emotionally with dog owners, along with images of pets using the products.

ThredUp

The blog and product pages stood out. Bullet points and small pieces of content break down complex ideas around sustainable fashion, and strong calls to action like “Shop Now” and “Explore the Edit” guide readers through the content easily.

charity: water

The nonprofit’s site tells impactful stories with visuals and clean typography. The storytelling is emotional and focused on individual people helped by clean water projects. Interactive maps and transparent financial breakdowns build trust and encourage donations.

What I learned

All three websites were highly engaging and informative. What made them stand out was the use of visuals, relatable language, and an easy-to-read format that was also emotionally impactful. The personal stories on charity: water, the fun tone and visuals on BarkBox, and the modern, clean design of ThredUp all made the content feel accessible. Each brand had a clear sense of identity and knew how to speak to its audience directly.